# Maple & Co. — 2025 Sales Insights

Prepared for Sarah, Maple & Co. Home Goods · Prepared by Aman Tiwari, Data Analyst · 30 October 2026 · Python · SQL · Power BI

Practice project: the client brief and dataset are simulated.

## Summary

In 2025 Maple & Co. earned **$218.6K revenue** and **$110.6K gross profit** (**50.6% margin**) from **3,459 delivered orders**. Sales grow through the year and **double in December**. The biggest problem is **Bedding**: it earns the most, but it is returned **more than twice as often** as any other category. Discounts above 10% cut margin without making orders bigger.

| Revenue | Gross profit | Margin | Orders |
|---|---|---|---|
| **$218.6K** | **$110.6K** | **50.6%** | **3,459** |
| AOV | Return rate | Repeat customers | Avg rating |
| **$63.18** | **6.8%** | **62.2%** | **4.13 / 5** |

Delivered orders only. Return rate uses delivered + returned orders.

## Top 5 insights

1. **December is the biggest month, at twice the monthly average.**

   December revenue was $36.7K against a $18.2K monthly average. November and December together brought in 29% of the year's revenue. February was the weakest month ($9.2K).

2. **Bedding earns the most, but it is also returned the most.**

   Bedding brings 30% of revenue and the most profit ($28.6K), but its return rate is **13.4%**; every other category is 4.7–5.5%. The three most profitable products are all Bedding, with return rates of 11.8–15.2%.

3. **Candles have the best margin.**

   Candles keep 64.7% of each sale as profit, the highest of any category. Bedding (44.1%) and Bath (45.3%) have the lowest.

4. **Bigger discounts shrink both margin and order size.**

   With no discount: 53.0% margin and a $66.97 average order. At 25% off: 39.1% margin and a $40.64 average order. Discounts are not making customers buy more.

5. **The website is the main channel, and most customers come back.**

   The website brings 45% of revenue, more than double Etsy (21%). Instagram brings 20% and Amazon 15%; AOV is similar everywhere ($62–65). 62% of customers ordered more than once. Regions: Northeast 26% and West 25% lead; Southwest trails at 10%.

## Recommendations for 2026

1. **Fix Bedding returns before buying more Bedding stock.** Check return reasons for the Waffle Throw Blanket, Cotton Sheet Set and Linen Duvet Cover. Add size charts, fabric photos and care details. Bringing returns down to the 5% level of other categories would mean about 60 fewer returned orders a year.

2. **Cap regular discounts at 10% and plan stock for Q4.** Keep deeper discounts for Black Friday. Order holiday stock by September, because November and December carry almost a third of yearly sales.

3. **Grow the website and reward repeat buyers.** The website is the biggest channel and has no marketplace fees. Use the 62% repeat base for a loyalty email (a thank-you offer on the second order), and push

high-margin Candles as add-ons and gift sets.

## Limitations

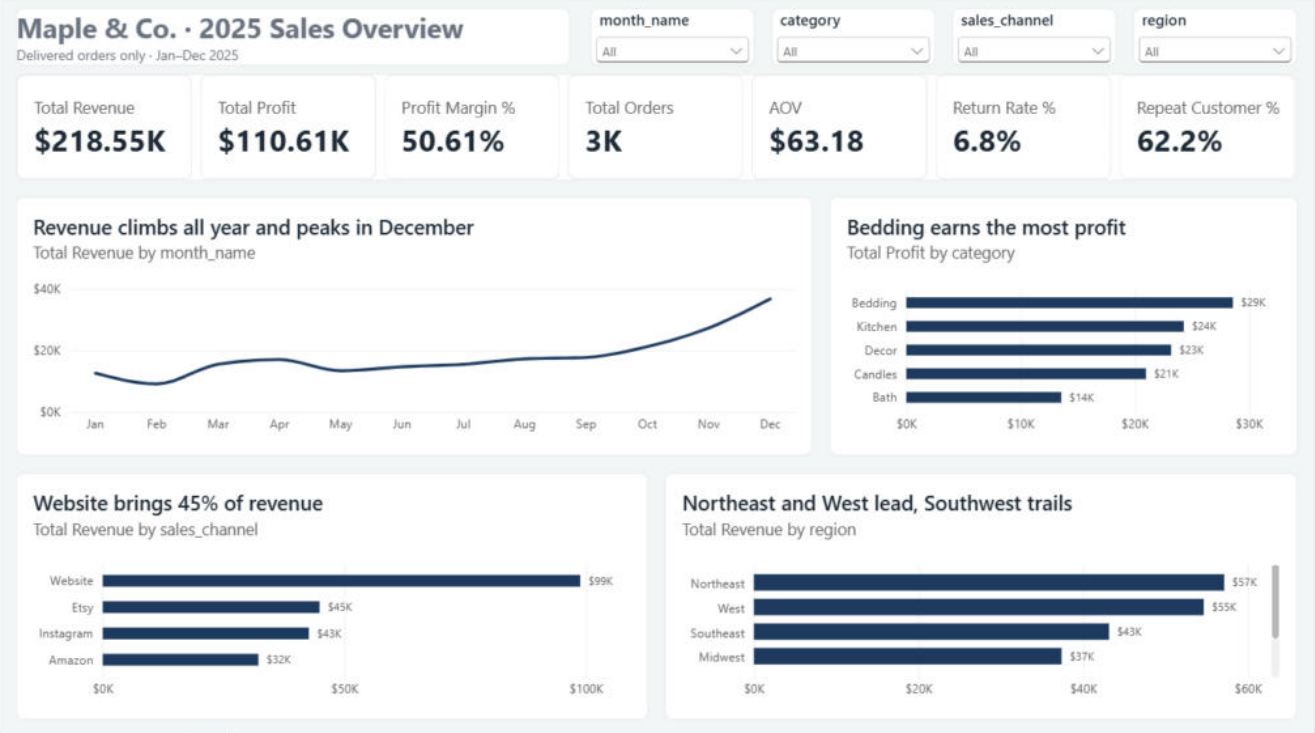
Marketplace fees and ad costs are not in the data, so Amazon and Etsy profit is overstated. Only one year of data is available. 17% of orders have no rating. No return reasons are recorded; adding this field is recommended.

## Data cleaning summary

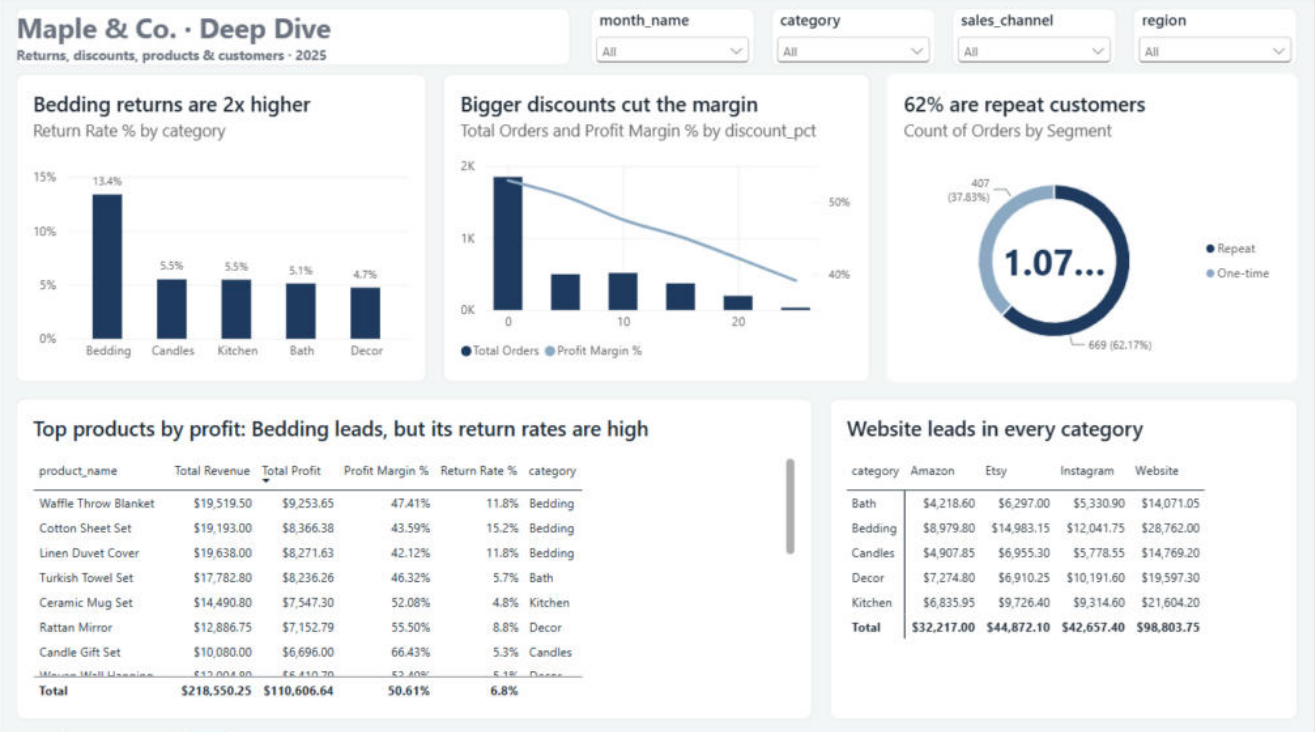
4,034 raw rows became 3,868 clean rows (3,459 delivered, 253 returned, 156 cancelled). Fixes: 9 test orders, 130 duplicate rows and 5 repeated order IDs removed; 22 zero or negative quantities removed; 3 quantity typos (200 → 2) fixed; dates in 3 formats standardised; 604 text prices converted; region and channel spellings standardised; 40 invalid ratings blanked; 1 missing product cost filled with the client's figure.

## Dashboard

Interactive Power BI dashboard, two pages, filterable by month, category, channel and region.




Page 1 · Overview




Page 2 · Deep Dive